-Intercultural competence

What we need to develop is a generalized intercultural competence-skills and habits of thought which will enhance our handling of any and all intercultural communication situations. Examples of such skills and habits of thought would include:

1. Minimization of ethnocentrism- learning not to assume that people of other cultures make the same assumptions we make about the world

2. Minimization of stereotyping- learning to be cautious about basing broad generalizations (especially negative ones) about other peoples and cultures on individual incidents or isolated bits of information.

3. Caution in interpretation and evaluation- learning not to jump to conclusions (especially negative ones) about what people of other cultures mean when they do or say things that seem puzzling or even threatening to us.

Snow, D. (2003). Intercultural competence in English classes: A brief reflection. *TESOL Intercultural Communications E-Section, 2*(2).